

WEEK
9

Pathology, Variation, Winter Dendrology, and Adversarial Identification

Instruction | retrieval | multi-organ practice | field-ready reference

Public learner edition

This packet contains the teaching guide, cumulative reference, and formative practice for the week. Secure graded assessments remain in the online course so unfamiliar examination specimens and answer material are not published.

Student / participant

Date started

Planned pace / study notes

Field standard

Identify the narrowest rank the visible evidence can defend. A common name OR a scientific name satisfies an ordinary identity prompt unless the activity explicitly tests nomenclature. State uncertainty instead of converting weak evidence into a confident species claim.

Use this packet alongside the online course at cochetopa.co/course/. Work the instruction first, complete retrieval without looking back, and use the secure online assessment when ready for grading.

Week 9 overview

Learning objectives

1. Discriminate black locust, tree-of-heaven, and white mulberry from native compound-leaved and variable-leaved trees.
2. Identify taxa under disease, insect, age, injury, weather, lichen, browse, and poor-view variation.
3. Identify American beech across the required bark and foliage-condition sequence while scoring host and condition separately.
4. Make calibrated winter identifications from twigs, buds, scars, pith, thorns, persistent structures, and site.
5. Choose genus, group, or insufficient evidence when adversarial material cannot defend species.

Species introduced this week

Common name	Scientific name	Family	Tier
Black locust	Robinia pseudoacacia	Fabaceae	C
Tree-of-heaven	Ailanthus altissima	Simaroubaceae	C
White mulberry	Morus alba	Moraceae	C

Cumulative review

80 taxa remain eligible. Earlier species do not disappear from retrieval merely because the weekly theme changes.

Confusion sets

Sugar / black / Norway maple: Petiole latex; leaf underside hair and stipules; bud size/shape; samara angle

Request: Fresh-broken petiole; lower surface; terminal bud; ripe samara

Red / silver maple: Sinus depth; lower-surface whiteness; spring samara size; twig odor; bark strips

Request: Complete leaf underside; samara with scale; crushed twig; mature bark

Striped / mountain maple: Green-white striped bark versus unstriped; leaf size/base; fruit cluster posture; growth form

Request: Young stem; intact leaf; fruit cluster; whole plant

White / green / black ash: Leaf-scar shape and bud position; leaflet stalks; samara wing extent; black-ash corky bark

Request: Twig node and leaf scar; whole rachis; samara; bark; hydrologic setting

Paper / heart-leaved / gray birch: Leaf base and vein count; twig resin glands; peeling versus tight bark; black branch marks; elevation

Request: Several mature leaves; resin-warty twig; bark sheet; whole growth form; location

Yellow / sweet birch: Both wintergreen; yellow birch golden curling bark and spur shoots versus sweet birch dark blocky bark

Request: Scratched twig; young and mature bark; fruiting strobile; lower leaf surface

White / black / red / Norway spruce: Cone size and scale margin; twig hairs; bud resin; foliage color/odor; pendulous branchlets

Request: Full cone; twig macro; bud; whole crown; regional site

Spruce / fir / hemlock: Woody pegs versus pad base versus petiole; needle cross-section; cone orientation and persistence

Request: Needle attachment macro; underside; terminal shoot; intact or attached cone

Red / jack / Scots / pitch pine: Fascicle count/length; bend test; cone curvature/prickles; upper-bole orange bark; epicormic shoots

Request: Several complete fascicles; cone and umbo; upper and lower bark; whole crown

Tamarack / European larch: Cone size and scale count/edge; needle cluster density; native peatland versus planting

Request: Full cone; spur shoot; cluster count; site/planting context

Red-oak group: Bud hair/size; lower-leaf hair; sinus architecture; acorn cup depth/rings; bark; site and branch angle

Request: Several sun leaves; terminal buds; complete acorn/cup; mature bark; whole crown

White-oak group: Lower-leaf felt; fruit stalk; fringed cup; chestnut teeth; bark architecture; site

Request: Lower surface; acorn/cup/stalk; terminal bud; upper and lower bole; site

Aspens / balsam poplar / cottonwood: Petiole flattening; tooth size; leaf base; bud size/stickiness/odor; bark and floodplain/upland context

Request: Complete leaf and petiole; bud; young and old bark; clonal form; site

American / slippery / rock / Siberian elm: Leaf roughness/base; bud hair; corky wings; samara hair/notch; bark layering; crown

Request: Leaf surfaces; buds; samara; corky twigs; existing bark section; crown

Black / pin / chokecherry: Fruit cluster architecture; petiole glands; lower-midvein hair; bark age; whole pioneer/clonal form
Request: Raceme or cluster; petiole macro; lower leaf; mature bark; whole plant

American hornbeam / eastern hophornbeam: Muscular smooth bole and three-lobed fruit bracts versus shreddy bark and hoplike sacs
Request: Bole; fruit; bud; wet versus dry site

Black walnut / butternut: Terminal leaflet; rachis/twig hair; light versus dark pith; round versus elongated nut; bark
Request: Whole leaf; pith section; nut/husk; twig hair; mature bark

Bitternut / shagbark / pignut / mockernut hickory: Terminal bud color/size/hair; leaflet count; rachis hair; husk thickness/dehiscence; bark
Request: Terminal bud; entire leaf; husk/nut; mature bark; twig hair

Northern white-cedar / Atlantic white-cedar / eastern redcedar: Flattened fans versus fine false-cypress sprays versus rounded juniper twigs; cone type; fruit color; wetland chemistry
Request: Full spray; seed cone or berry-like cone; bark; site

Native compound leaves / invasive confusers: Opposite/alternate; bud position; leaflet glands; thorns; pith; leaf scar; odor; fruit type
Request: Intact leaf plus node; bud/leaf scar; pith; samara/pod/nut; leaflet base

Yellow birch / black cherry bark: Golden horizontal curls and wintergreen twig versus burnt-chip plates, petiole glands, and almond twig odor
Request: Young and old bark; scratched twig; leaf petiole and underside; fruit

Serviceberry / mountain-ashes / chokecherry: Simple versus compound leaves; pome calyx versus drupe; leaflet proportions; buds; fruit architecture
Request: Whole leaf; fruit close-up; bud; flowers; multiple leaves

Flowering / pagoda dogwood: Opposite versus alternate branching; red versus blue-black fruit; flower bud; crown tiers
Request: Intact twig nodes; fruit; bud; whole crown

White mulberry / sassafras / basswood: Latex and variable coarse leaves; sassafras aroma/mixed shapes; basswood asymmetric heart base and bracted fruit
Request: Fresh twig/petiole; multiple leaves; fruit; buds; bark

Assessment schedule

Assessment	Type	Items	Time
W09-PRACTICAL	weekly identification practical	30	65 min
W09-BEECH-CONDITION	american beech condition laboratory	24	60 min
W09-ADVERSARIAL-WINTER	adversarial winter damage practical	30	70 min

Five-session field workflow

Session A - Planted and invasive confusers

native-versus-invasive character combinations. Modalities: foliage, bark, reproductive, dormant, whole tree context.

☐ Session A completed (enter X)

Session B - Winter and invasive-confuser retrieval

unfamiliar partial winter specimens. Modalities: bark, reproductive, dormant, whole tree context.

☐ Session B completed (enter X)

Session C - American beech condition laboratory

host-identification and condition-diagnosis stations scored separately. Modalities: foliage, bark, whole tree context, condition.

☐ Session C completed (enter X)

Session D - Adversarial winter and damage laboratory

poor views damaged material disease effects and insufficient-evidence stations. Modalities: foliage, bark, reproductive, dormant, whole tree context, condition.

☐ Session D completed (enter X)

Session E - No weak species disappears

adversarial adaptive retrieval and targeted remediation. Modalities: foliage, bark, reproductive, dormant, whole tree context, condition.

☐ Session E completed (enter X)

Evidence-to-decision protocol

Step	Field action
1. Inventory	Name only what is visible: organ, arrangement, attachment, surface, scale, maturity, damage, and context.
2. Generate	Name the leading identity and the nearest plausible alternative before seeking confirmation.
3. Separate	Cite the visible character that changes the decision; do not substitute habitat or color alone for structure.
4. Calibrate	Use species, genus, or insufficient evidence according to the photograph, not according to what you hope it shows.
5. Request	Ask for the single additional view with the highest expected diagnostic value.

Part I - Species instruction atlas

These profiles are labeled teaching material. Photographs come only from the teaching pool; no exact image in the formal assessment section appears here.

Black locust - *Robinia pseudoacacia*

New this week | Family: Fabaceae | Tier C | Priority 3 - recognition/confuser

Introduced and naturalized in settled portions of the region

Nitrogen-fixing clonal invader and compound-leaved confuser



Condition

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Dormant

no rights reserved
INAT_PHOTO_725467368 | cc0



Foliage

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Evidence	Diagnostic interpretation
Foliage	Alternate pinnately compound leaves usually carry 7 to 19 oval, thin, entire leaflets with a terminal leaflet. Paired stipular spines occur at many nodes, though vigorous, old, or cultivated shoots may be weakly armed or thornless.
Bark age series	Young stems are smooth greenish to reddish-brown with lenticels; older bark becomes dark gray-brown and deeply furrowed into thick interlacing rope-like ridges. Old clonal stems often lean, fork, or decay.
Dormant	Zigzag alternate twigs have small buds recessed beneath the leaf scar and often a pair of short stout stipular spines at each node; the pith is continuous rather than chambered. Spine absence on one twig does not exclude cultivated or mature black locust.
Fruit / cone / seed	Fragrant white pea-shaped flowers hang in showy drooping racemes; flat smooth brown legumes contain several beanlike seeds and often persist into winter. Flowers or pods combined with pinnate foliage are decisive.
Whole tree / context	A medium, often crooked tree forming dense root-sucker colonies on old fields, roadsides, disturbed slopes, mine lands, rail corridors, and forest edges. Clone form is strong context but not an independent species character.
Variation / condition	Cultivars may be thornless or differently crowned; locust leafminer browns foliage, locust borer and heart rot deform boles, and repeated cutting produces dense juvenile sprouts with more prominent spines.
Evidence limit	Alternate pinnate leaves, paired stipular spines, recessed buds, and flat pods support species. Compound foliage alone may overlap native trees and tree-of-heaven, while ropey bark alone overlaps other mature hardwoods.

Confuser control

Alternative	Visible separator	Resolving view
<i>Ailanthus altissima</i>	Tree-of-heaven has far larger leaves with many mostly entire leaflets bearing gland-tipped basal teeth, stout twigs with large heart-shaped scars, and twisted samaras; black locust has smaller oval leaflets, paired node spines, pea flowers, and flat pods.	Leaflet bases and margins, a complete node with bud and spines, twig pith, and attached fruit.
<i>Fraxinus</i> and <i>Juglans</i> species	Ash has opposite compound leaves and opposite buds; walnuts have serrate leaflets, prominent bundle scars, chambered pith, and nuts. Black locust is alternate with entire leaflets, stipular spines, recessed buds, and legumes.	Two consecutive nodes showing arrangement, leaflet margins, pith in cross-section, buds and leaf scars, and fruit.

Silvics capsule

Dimension	Field-use summary
Shade tolerance	Very shade intolerant; rapid juvenile growth occurs in full light, while shaded stems decline and fail to recruit beneath closed canopy.
Moisture / soils	Adaptable to many well-drained soils, including droughty, eroded, compacted, and nutrient-poor disturbed ground; performs poorly under prolonged flooding and on deeply shaded sites.
Geographic affinity	Native farther south and west of much of the course region but widely planted and naturalized across the Great Lakes, Northeast, southern Canada, and Allegheny landscapes.
Associations	Most common in old fields, roadsides, forest edges, mine reclamation, utility corridors, and disturbed oak or mixed-hardwood sites rather than intact northern-hardwood interiors.
Regeneration	Hard-coated seed can remain viable and germinate after scarification, but local stand expansion is usually driven by root suckers and sprouts following disturbance.
Vegetative reproduction	Root suckering and stump sprouting are extremely vigorous; cutting a clone without follow-up commonly multiplies stems and expands the patch.
Seed / mast	Flat pods are produced regularly by trees in full light; hard seed coats impose dormancy and permit a persistent seed reserve until abrasion, heat, or other scarification.
Establishment	Open light and exposed or disturbed soil favor seedlings, while vegetative shoots emerge from established root systems across grassland and edge competition.
Succession	Aggressive early-seral colonizer and clonal edge invader that enriches soil nitrogen but is usually overtopped by taller shade-tolerant trees if disturbance ceases.
Disturbance response	Cutting, fire top-kill, mowing, and soil disturbance stimulate sprouts and suckers; repeated integrated treatment is required where removal is the objective.
Longevity / growth	Very rapid early growth, early reproduction, and relatively short useful lifespan; locust borer, decay, and poor form commonly limit mature timber quality.
Browse	Young foliage and sprouts are browsed by deer and livestock, while stipular spines provide incomplete protection; all plant parts require toxicity caution for livestock and people.
Insects / disease	Locust borer and locust leafminer are conspicuous regional agents; heart rot, witches'-broom, cankers, and storm breakage further reduce vigor and form.
Management	Recognize clones before disturbance, avoid one-time cutting as control, and weigh erosion control, wildlife, durable wood, nitrogen enrichment, and invasive spread against site objectives.
Silvicultural systems	Heavy opening releases seedlings and clones, while closed-canopy systems suppress it; timber coppice can exploit sprouting, but invasive control requires repeated cutting or treatment of both stems and roots.

Personal field cue for Black locust

learner-created retrieval hook

Tree-of-heaven - *Ailanthus altissima*

New this week | Family: Simaroubaceae | Tier C | Priority 3 - recognition/confuser

Urban/disturbed PA/NJ, NY, southern New England, and Great Lakes; expanding northward

Rapid clonal invasive with allelopathic effects; major compound-leaved confuser



Foliage

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INAT_PHOTO_714730962 | cc-by



Reproductive

no rights reserved
INAT_PHOTO_722823689 | cc0



Whole Tree Context

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Evidence	Diagnostic interpretation
Foliage	Very large alternate pinnately compound leaves carry many long leaflets that are otherwise nearly entire but have one to several coarse basal teeth or lobes, each ending in a gland. Crushed foliage has a strong rancid odor; use odor only as safe wafted corroboration.
Bark age series	Sapling bark is smooth greenish-gray to pale gray with conspicuous lenticels; older bark remains relatively smooth for years, then develops pale shallow fissures and a striped or cantaloupe-rind pattern rather than deep ropey ridges.
Dormant	Stout tan to reddish twigs have very large heart- or shield-shaped leaf scars with many bundle scars, small dome-like buds partly hidden above the scar, and a broad continuous spongy brown pith. Twigs are unarmed.
Fruit / cone / seed	Large terminal panicles bear small greenish flowers; female trees develop masses of narrow twisted papery samaras with a seed near the center, ripening yellow, orange, pink, or brown and often persisting.
Whole tree / context	A fast-growing tree with coarse open branches and frequent dense root-sucker colonies along city lots, roads, railways, quarries, cliffs, and disturbed forest edges. Suckers may arise far from the parent stem.
Variation / condition	Seedlings, stump sprouts, and root suckers carry especially huge leaves and stout twigs; male and female trees differ in fruit, cold injury alters crowns, and repeated cutting creates shrubby colonies. Spotted lanternfly presence is not host-identification proof.
Evidence limit	Basal gland-tipped leaflet teeth plus enormous alternate leaves, large heart-shaped scars, brown pith, or central-seeded samaras support species. A cropped compound leaf lacking its base or a distant sucker patch cannot exclude walnut, sumac, or other compound-leaved trees.

Confuser control

Alternative	Visible separator	Resolving view
Juglans nigra and Juglans cinerea	Walnut leaflets are serrate along most of the margin, twigs have chambered pith and different leaf scars, and fruit is a large husked nut; tree-of-heaven leaflets are mostly entire with glandular basal teeth, pith is continuous, and fruit is a samara.	Leaflet bases and full margins, twig pith in longitudinal section, leaf scars and buds, and attached fruit.
Rhus and Robinia species	Sumacs commonly have serrate leaflets, hairy or glaucous twigs, and dense red drupe clusters; black locust has smaller entire oval leaflets, paired stipular spines, recessed buds, and pods. Tree-of-heaven has basal glandular teeth, huge scars, and twisted samaras.	Complete leaf and terminal leaflet, twig surface and node, basal leaflet glands, pith, and fruit cluster.

Silvics capsule

Dimension	Field-use summary
Shade tolerance	Seedlings tolerate some partial shade briefly, but the species is fundamentally light-demanding; rapid height growth and clonal expansion are strongest in openings.
Moisture / soils	Extremely adaptable to dry, compacted, polluted, rocky, calcareous, and disturbed soils, though growth improves with moisture and fertility; intolerant of prolonged deep flooding.

Dimension	Field-use summary
Geographic affinity	Introduced from Asia and widespread in urban and disturbed eastern North America, with northern expansion limited mainly by cold and growing-season length.
Associations	Occurs in urban lots, transport corridors, cliffs, mines, riparian disturbances, forest edges, and canopy gaps with other invasive or early-seral hardwoods.
Regeneration	Female trees produce abundant wind-dispersed samaras that germinate readily on disturbed soil; established plants expand more aggressively through roots and sprouts.
Vegetative reproduction	Root suckers, stump sprouts, and shoot replacement are vigorous; cutting or girdling without effective follow-up can provoke dense clonal regeneration.
Seed / mast	Large samara crops occur on mature female trees and disperse over substantial distances; seed is generally short-lived compared with a persistent hard-seed bank.
Establishment	Bare or disturbed soil and canopy openings favor seedlings, while root-connected suckers can emerge through existing vegetation and rapidly occupy new light.
Succession	Aggressive early-seral invader of disturbances and gaps; clones may persist and suppress competitors through rapid growth, dense sprouting, and chemical effects.
Disturbance response	Logging, soil disturbance, road work, fire top-kill, and single cutting events often stimulate spread; effective control must address both seed sources and the root system over multiple years.
Longevity / growth	Exceptionally rapid juvenile growth and early reproduction, with moderate individual stem longevity but long clonal persistence through replacement shoots.
Browse	Strong odor and secondary compounds reduce palatability to many herbivores, so deer pressure can indirectly favor it over more palatable native regeneration.
Insects / disease	Tree-of-heaven is a favored host of spotted lanternfly; Verticillium wilt and other pathogens can cause decline, but insects or disease presence must not substitute for morphology.
Management	Map female seed sources and clone extent, prevent harvest and road work from spreading it, and use repeated integrated control rather than cutting alone; monitor treated sites for several growing seasons.
Silvicultural systems	Large gaps and even-aged harvests favor establishment and sucker release; maintaining competitive native cover can reduce invasion risk, while infested stands require preharvest control and follow-up.

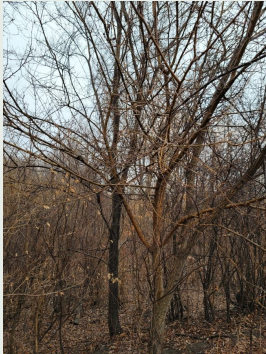
Personal field cue for Tree-of-heaven
learner-created retrieval hook

White mulberry - *Morus alba*

New this week | Family: Moraceae | Tier C | Priority 3 - recognition/confuser

Planted and naturalized in settled Great Lakes, southern ON, NY, PA/NJ, and southern New England

Variable-leaved invasive/naturalized tree that hybridizes with red mulberry



Bark

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Dormant

(c) Kenneth Burdick, some rights...
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Foliage

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Evidence	Diagnostic interpretation
Foliage	Alternate simple leaves on one shoot may be unlobed, mitten-shaped, or deeply multi-lobed; margins are serrate, bases rounded to heart-shaped, and upper surfaces usually smooth to slightly glossy rather than strongly sandpapery. Broken petioles or twigs exude milky latex.
Bark age series	Young bark is smooth yellowish- to orange-brown with lenticels; mature bark becomes gray-brown to orange-brown and develops irregular interlacing ridges and furrows. Bark is supportive but not reliable against other planted or naturalized trees.
Dormant	Slender alternate zigzag twigs end in a false terminal bud and carry small appressed ovoid buds with several scales; leaf scars are small and rounded. Milky latex from a fresh break supports <i>Morus</i> but should not be contacted unnecessarily.
Fruit / cone / seed	Separate tiny flowers occur in short catkin-like clusters; many flowers fuse into a blackberry-like multiple fruit that may ripen white, pink, red, purple, or nearly black. Fruit color does not reliably separate white from red mulberry.
Whole tree / context	A small to medium, broad-crowned tree of farmsteads, fencerows, urban ground, roadsides, old fields, and forest edges, often planted or bird-dispersed near settlement.
Variation / condition	Leaf lobing changes dramatically with shoot vigor and age; cultivars vary in fruit and form, and introgression with native red mulberry creates intermediates. One photograph cannot establish a genetically pure individual.
Evidence limit	Variable serrate foliage, milky latex, buds, and multiple fruit support <i>Morus</i> . Species-level separation from red mulberry can be unreliable from one leaf or fruit color, especially where hybrids occur; record <i>Morus</i> or a hybrid complex when characters conflict.

Confuser control

Alternative	Visible separator	Resolving view
<i>Morus rubra</i>	Red mulberry typically has a rough sandpapery upper surface and denser soft pubescence beneath, especially along veins, while white mulberry is often smoother and glossier; fruit color overlaps and hybridization makes intermediates common.	Several mature sun leaves from reproductive shoots, upper-surface texture, lower-surface pubescence, buds, fruiting material, and planting or population context.
<i>Tilia americana</i> and <i>Sassafras albidum</i>	Basswood leaves are consistently unlobed with a strongly uneven cordate base and fruits attached to a leafy bract; sassafras has smooth entire margins, aromatic twigs, and blue drupes. Mulberry combines serration, extreme lobe variation, latex, and multiple fruits.	Full shoot showing leaf variation and arrangement, fresh petiole latex, buds, and complete reproductive structures.

Silvics capsule

Dimension	Field-use summary
Shade tolerance	Best in full sun and tolerant of partial shade, but generally unable to recruit or maintain rapid growth beneath a closed forest canopy.
Moisture / soils	Adaptable to moist or dry well-drained soils, urban compaction, varied pH, and disturbed ground; prolonged flooding and severe shade reduce performance.

Dimension	Field-use summary
Geographic affinity	Introduced from Asia, planted widely for silk production and ornament, and now naturalized across settled temperate parts of the course region.
Associations	Most frequent in fencerows, farm woods, roadsides, riparian edges, old fields, vacant lots, and disturbed hardwood margins rather than closed northern hardwood interiors.
Regeneration	Birds and mammals disperse the many small seeds in fleshy multiple fruits; seedlings establish readily in open disturbed microsites and beneath perches.
Vegetative reproduction	Cut or damaged trees can stump-sprout and produce basal shoots, but bird-dispersed seed is the principal landscape-scale spread mechanism.
Seed / mast	Fruit can be abundant and is produced regularly by mature trees; wildlife rapidly consumes and disperses seed, creating scattered recruits around settlement.
Establishment	Light, exposed or lightly vegetated soil, and nearby perches or seed sources favor recruitment; seedlings tolerate urban stress once established.
Succession	Early-seral and edge species that invades disturbed ground but is usually overtopped in long-undisturbed closed forest.
Disturbance response	Cutting stimulates sprouts and soil disturbance creates seedbeds; repeated removal is needed where control is desired, and disturbed edges remain vulnerable to reinvasion by birds.
Longevity / growth	Fast to moderate early growth, small- to medium-tree stature, broad crown, and moderate lifespan; older stems often become irregular or decay-prone.
Browse	Leaves and shoots are palatable to livestock and wildlife, but abundant bird-dispersed seed and sprouting allow persistence in settled landscapes.
Insects / disease	Popcorn disease of fruit, bacterial blight, cankers, leaf spots, borers, scale insects, and storm damage occur; no single agent normally prevents naturalization.
Management	Avoid forcing white-versus-red identification on ambiguous or hybrid material, retain native red mulberry where confirmed, and remove fruiting white mulberry plus sprouts when genetic or invasive impacts are objectives.
Silvicultural systems	Forest openings and edge disturbance favor establishment; maintaining closed native canopy suppresses recruitment, while removal requires stump follow-up and monitoring for bird-dispersed seedlings.

Personal field cue for White mulberry

learner-created retrieval hook

Part II - Cumulative rapid-reference atlas

Use this as a field briefing, not as a substitute for retrieval. Earlier taxa are compressed here so the packet remains self-contained while preserving space for unfamiliar assessment images.

Taxon	High-value visible evidence	Silvics anchor
Sugar maple <i>Acer saccharum</i>	Foliage: Opposite, simple blades are palmately veined and usually five-lobed, with pointed lobes, broad rounded U-shaped... Bark: Seedlings and saplings have smooth light-gray bark; pole trees develop long shallow furrows; mature and old... Dormant: Opposite brown twigs carry a narrow, sharply pointed terminal bud with many tightly overlapping...	Tolerance: Very shade tolerant; seedlings and saplings can persist for years as advance... Site: Best on cool, fertile, moist but well-drained loams with adequate calcium and magnesium; performs...
Red maple <i>Acer rubrum</i>	Foliage: Opposite, simple blades usually have three to five lobes, angular or V-shaped sinuses, and regular serration... Bark: Young stems are smooth and light gray; intermediate bark develops narrow vertical cracks and small scaly plates;... Dormant: Opposite reddish twigs bear blunt-ovoid red buds with several pairs of scales; flower buds are...	Tolerance: Moderately shade tolerant when young and able to persist beneath partial canopy... Site: Occupies an exceptionally broad range from saturated swamps and floodplains to dry ridges; local seed...
American beech <i>Fagus grandifolia</i>	Foliage: Alternate, simple leaves are elliptic to ovate with a short petiole, straight parallel lateral veins, and one... Bark: Saplings and healthy mature trees have thin, smooth, pale bluish-gray bark, often compared with elephant hide... Dormant: Alternate twigs carry exceptionally long, slender, sharply pointed cigar-shaped buds with many...	Tolerance: Exceptionally shade tolerant; seedlings, saplings, and root suckers can persist... Site: Most competitive on moist, well-drained, often fertile loams and slopes; absent from persistently...
Yellow birch <i>Betula alleghaniensis</i>	Foliage: Alternate ovate leaves have a rounded to weakly heart-shaped base, many straight lateral veins, and sharply... Bark: Seedlings are gray-brown and unremarkable; intermediate stems develop bronze to yellow-gold bark with horizontal... Dormant: Slender alternate twigs bear pointed reddish-brown buds, small spur shoots, and no true terminal...	Tolerance: Intermediate in shade tolerance: more tolerant than paper birch and aspen, but... Site: Best on cool, moist, well-drained, fertile loams and coves; common on north and east slopes, seepage...
Paper birch <i>Betula papyrifera</i>	Foliage: Alternate ovate to triangular leaves have a rounded or wedge-shaped base, pointed tip, and doubly serrate... Bark: Young stems are reddish-brown with pale horizontal lenticels and do not look white; pole and mature bark becomes... Dormant: Slender reddish-brown alternate twigs have pointed appressed buds, conspicuous resin glands or...	Tolerance: Very shade intolerant; seedlings require abundant light and are rapidly overtopped... Site: Occupies cool sites across a broad moisture range, from well-drained glacial tills and sandy soils to...
Eastern hemlock <i>Tsuga canadensis</i>	Foliage: Short, flat, mostly blunt single needles vary in length along delicate twigs, show two pale stomatal bands... Bark: Young bark is smooth gray-brown; intermediate stems develop narrow scaly ridges; mature bark becomes dark gray... Dormant: Fine flexible yellow-brown twigs carry minute rounded buds, tiny petiolate needles, and often a...	Tolerance: Extremely shade tolerant, among the most tolerant North American trees; seedlings... Site: Favors cool, humid, sheltered sites with reliable moisture and generally well-drained acidic to...
American basswood <i>Tilia americana</i>	Foliage: Alternate, broadly ovate to heart-shaped leaves have an abruptly pointed tip, serrate margin, palmate basal... Bark: Young bark is smooth gray to gray-brown; intermediate bark develops narrow vertical fissures; old boles are dark... Dormant: Alternate zigzag twigs carry plump red to reddish-brown ovoid buds with only two or three...	Tolerance: Shade tolerant, though generally less persistent in deep shade than beech or sugar... Site: Best on deep, fertile, moist, well-drained loams with high base status, especially calcium-rich tills...
Black cherry <i>Prunus serotina</i>	Foliage: Alternate, simple, elliptic leaves have fine rounded or incurved teeth, one or more small glands near the top of... Bark: Young stems are smooth reddish-brown to dark gray with prominent horizontal lenticels; intermediate bark breaks... Dormant: Slender alternate reddish-brown twigs carry small ovoid scaled buds and semicircular leaf scars;...	Tolerance: Shade intolerant; seedlings may survive briefly under partial canopy, but... Site: Best on deep, fertile, moist but well-drained loams, especially Allegheny uplands and protected...
Eastern hophornbeam <i>Ostrya virginiana</i>	Foliage: Alternate ovate leaves have many straight lateral veins, a sharply pointed tip, and a doubly serrate margin; the... Bark: Young stems are smooth gray-brown with lenticels; older small trunks break into narrow, loose, vertical gray... Dormant: Slender alternate twigs bear short pointed ovoid buds with many visible scales; several...	Tolerance: Shade tolerant and able to persist as a slow-growing understory tree beneath... Site: Common on dry-mesic to mesic, well-drained, often rocky or calcareous soils; avoids prolonged flooding...
Black maple <i>Acer nigrum</i>	Foliage: Opposite blades are usually three-lobed, broad and somewhat drooping, with a deeply heart-shaped base, few... Bark: Young bark is gray and fairly smooth; older boles become dark gray-brown with irregular furrows and firm plates... Dormant: Opposite brown twigs carry a pointed terminal bud and smaller paired laterals. Bud, twig, and...	Tolerance: Very shade tolerant when young, broadly like sugar maple; suppressed advance... Site: Best on fertile, moist, well-drained loams and alluvium, often over calcareous or otherwise base-rich...
Striped maple <i>Acer pensylvanicum</i>	Foliage: Opposite, large, thin blades have three shallow forward-pointing lobes, a broad heart-shaped base, and fine... Bark: Saplings have smooth green bark marked by conspicuous vertical white stripes; older stems turn greenish brown to... Dormant: Opposite green to green-brown twigs and young stems retain longitudinal pale stripes; paired...	Tolerance: Very shade tolerant; survives decades suppressed but grows best under moderate... Site: Favors cool, moist, well-drained sandy loams, commonly acidic, and avoids both stagnant wetness and...
Mountain maple <i>Acer spicatum</i>	Foliage: Opposite blades are usually three-lobed, sometimes weakly five-lobed, with sharply pointed lobes and coarse... Bark: Young stems are reddish to gray-brown without white longitudinal stripes; older small trunks remain thin-barked... Dormant: Slender opposite twigs carry small pointed paired buds and a terminal bud; stems lack striped...	Tolerance: Moderately shade tolerant and able to persist beneath canopy, but density and... Site: Favors cool, moist, well-drained upland soils, rocky slopes, ravines, and streamside benches; drought...
Norway maple <i>Acer platanoides</i>	Foliage: Opposite, broad blades usually have five sharply pointed lobes and sparse large teeth. A freshly broken petiole... Bark: Young bark is smooth gray; mature bark develops regular narrow vertical ridges and shallow interlacing furrows... Dormant: Opposite stout twigs bear large plump terminal buds and paired lateral buds, commonly reddish...	Tolerance: Seedlings are shade tolerant to very shade tolerant and form persistent seedling... Site: Broadly site tolerant, performing especially well on cool moist rich soils while also tolerating urban...
Heart-leaved paper birch <i>Betula cordifolia</i>	Foliage: Alternate ovate leaves have a distinctly heart-shaped base, a pointed but not long-drawn tip, double teeth, and... Bark: Young stems are reddish to brown; mature bark becomes pink-white, brown-white, or red-brown-white and exfoliates... Dormant: Alternate twigs lack a true terminal bud and carry small ovoid imbricate buds; short shoots...	Tolerance: Generally shade intolerant to intermediate; seedlings and crowns perform best in... Site: Favors cool, moist, well-drained, often rocky or talus-derived upland soils and is poorly suited to...
Gray birch <i>Betula populifolia</i>	Foliage: Alternate glossy blades are triangular to rhombic-triangular with a long narrow tip, coarse double teeth, and... Bark: Young bark is brown to reddish; saplings and small trees become chalky gray-white with dark triangular chevrons... Dormant: Slender alternate twigs lack a true terminal bud, show lenticels and small resin glands, and...	Tolerance: Very shade intolerant; recruitment and persistence require open conditions. Site: Grows from moist well-drained margins to dry infertile sands, gravels, rocky slopes, and acidic...

Taxon	High-value visible evidence	Silvics anchor
Sweet birch <i>Betula lenta</i>	Foliage: Alternate ovate to narrow-ovate leaves are finely and regularly double-serrate, usually with at least six teeth... Bark: Young bark is smooth reddish brown with horizontal lenticels and can resemble cherry; mature bark becomes dark... Dormant: Slender reddish-brown twigs lack a true terminal bud and carry small pointed imbricate buds; a...	Tolerance: Classed as shade intolerant overall, although seedlings benefit from side shade or... Site: Best on moist well-drained soils and protected north- or east-facing slopes; tolerates rocky shallow...
Pin cherry <i>Prunus pensylvanica</i>	Foliage: Alternate thin leaves are narrow-ovate to lanceolate, long-pointed, finely serrate, and largely glabrous; one or... Bark: Young bark is shiny reddish brown with strong horizontal lenticels; older thin bark becomes gray-brown and may... Dormant: Slender reddish-brown twigs show horizontal lenticels and small sharp imbricate buds, including a...	Tolerance: Very shade intolerant; establishment and survival are concentrated in large openings. Site: Occupies coarse to medium soils from rocky ledges and sands to moist loams, but is generally absent...
Chokecherry <i>Prunus virginiana</i>	Foliage: Alternate oblong to obovate leaves have sharply pointed teeth, mostly 8-11 pairs of lateral veins, and a mostly... Bark: Young stems are reddish to gray-brown with horizontal lenticels; older small trunks remain relatively thin and... Dormant: Slender brown to reddish twigs have obvious lenticels and sharp imbricate buds. The winter twig...	Tolerance: Shade tolerant enough to persist under forest canopy, but reaches greatest density... Site: Broadly adaptable from mesic forest edges and riparian terraces to dry-mesic thickets, provided...
American hornbeam <i>Carpinus caroliniana</i>	Foliage: Alternate elliptic to ovate leaves have a symmetrical rounded or shallowly cordate base, strong straight... Bark: Young and mature bark remains thin, smooth, blue-gray to slate gray, while the trunk develops distinctive sinewy... Dormant: Slender alternate twigs lack a true terminal bud; narrow ovoid buds have many overlapping scales...	Tolerance: Very shade tolerant as a seedling and sapling; tolerance declines with age, so... Site: Best on rich loams with high water-holding capacity, from somewhat poorly drained to well drained...
Pagoda dogwood <i>Cornus alternifolia</i>	Foliage: Leaves are alternate, though crowded near shoot tips, with entire to slightly wavy margins and several strong... Bark: Young stems are smooth reddish to green-brown; mature bark becomes gray-brown with shallow ridges or small... Dormant: Leaves and buds are alternate, often clustered near upturned branch tips; slender twigs are...	Tolerance: Shade tolerant and able to dominate locally in mature-forest understories, while... Site: Favors cool, rich, moist, well-drained forest soils and edges; drought and heat stress increase decline.
Smooth serviceberry <i>Amelanchier laevis</i>	Foliage: Alternate ovate to elliptic leaves are sharply toothed; at flowering they are already partly expanded and... Bark: Young stems and twigs are reddish; older bark remains thin and smooth gray with pale vertical stripes, later... Dormant: Slender alternate reddish-brown twigs have narrow pointed imbricate buds, a terminal bud,...	Tolerance: Tolerates understory shade but flowers, fruits, and develops best with partial sun... Site: Prefers moist, moderately to well-drained acidic to neutral soils and tolerates rocky forest sites if...
Balsam fir <i>Abies balsamea</i>	Foliage: Needles are single, soft, flattened, aromatic when crushed, and usually arranged in two lateral ranks on lower... Bark: Sapling bark is thin, smooth, gray, and commonly dotted with conspicuous raised resin blisters. Intermediate... Dormant: Slender gray-brown twigs are relatively smooth after needles fall, with round flush leaf scars...	Tolerance: Very shade tolerant; seedlings can persist for decades as advance regeneration and... Site: Occupies moist cool sites from poorly drained organic and fine-textured lowlands to well-drained...
White spruce <i>Picea glauca</i>	Foliage: Needles are single, stiff, sharp, four-angled to somewhat flattened, and roll between the fingers; each stands... Bark: Young bark is thin, smoothish, gray to brown, becoming scaly early. Intermediate and mature bark forms thin... Dormant: Current branchlets are light brown to pink-brown, usually hairless, and coated with a thin...	Tolerance: Intermediate in shade tolerance; more tolerant than jack or red pine and the... Site: Grows across a wide moisture range but performs best on moist, well-drained, relatively fertile loams...
Black spruce <i>Picea mariana</i>	Foliage: Short single needles are four-angled, stiff, dull gray- to blue-green, glaucous, and borne around the twig on... Bark: Saplings have thin gray-brown bark with fine scales; intermediate and mature stems become dark gray to reddish... Dormant: Young yellow-brown branchlets lack bloom and are minutely hairy; at least some hairs are gland...	Tolerance: Shade tolerant, especially as a seedling, but generally less tolerant than balsam... Site: Dominant on cold acidic peatlands, poorly drained organic soils, and nutrient-poor mineral sites,...
Red spruce <i>Picea rubens</i>	Foliage: Single sharp four-angled needles stand around the twig on woody pegs and roll between the fingers. They are... Bark: Young bark is smoothish gray-brown to reddish brown and soon develops thin flaky scales. Mature bark becomes... Dormant: Yellow-brown current branchlets are minutely hairy without a glaucous bloom; the hairs are...	Tolerance: Very shade tolerant, broadly comparable to balsam fir and more tolerant than white... Site: Best in cool humid climates on moist acidic, commonly shallow or stony soils with thick organic...
Norway spruce <i>Picea abies</i>	Foliage: Needles are single, stiff, sharp, four-angled, dark green, and borne on woody pegs around the shoot. They... Bark: Young bark is smoothish gray-brown to reddish brown, becoming finely scaly. Older trunks develop gray to brown... Dormant: Reddish-brown branchlets carry prominent woody needle pegs and pointed reddish-brown, usually...	Tolerance: Moderately shade tolerant as a young tree, but plantation growth and crown... Site: Prefers cool, moist, well-drained, commonly acidic loams or sandy loams; prolonged saturation, heat,...
Eastern white pine <i>Pinus strobus</i>	Foliage: Soft, slender, flexible blue-green needles occur in fascicles of five, one for each letter in 'white'; they are... Bark: Seedlings and young saplings have smooth thin gray-green bark. Intermediate stems become gray with shallow... Dormant: Twigs are slender and gray-brown, with a conspicuous terminal cluster of long narrow pointed...	Tolerance: Intermediate in shade tolerance; seedlings tolerate substantial shelter, but... Site: Occurs on many soils and is competitive on sandy, rocky, or glacial deposits; best growth is on moist,...
Red pine <i>Pinus resinosa</i>	Foliage: Needles occur in fascicles of two, are dark green, relatively straight, and usually 9-16 cm long. They are... Bark: Young stems have thin gray to reddish scaly bark. Intermediate and mature boles develop conspicuous orange-red... Dormant: Stout orange-brown branchlets end in clustered ovoid red-brown buds, usually resinous. Persistent...	Tolerance: Shade intolerant; seedlings and saplings need nearly full light, and crowns recede... Site: Best known on well-drained sands, gravels, and rocky ridges, though highest productivity occurs on...
Jack pine <i>Pinus banksiana</i>	Foliage: Needles occur in fascicles of two, are short, stiff, yellow- to gray-green, and usually 2-5 cm long. Each pair... Bark: Sapling bark is thin, dull gray to reddish brown, and finely scaly. Mature stems remain relatively thin-barked... Dormant: Slender gray-brown twigs bear small ovoid resinous buds and persistent paired fascicle sheaths...	Tolerance: Very shade intolerant, among the least tolerant northern conifers; seedlings... Site: Most competitive on dry nutrient-poor sands, dunes, outwash, and barrens, but also occurs on rocky...
Scots pine <i>Pinus sylvestris</i>	Foliage: Needles occur in fascicles of two, are stiff, noticeably twisted, often blue- or gray-green, and usually 3-7 cm... Bark: Young branches and upper trunks develop thin flaky cinnamon- to bright orange-brown bark, a major field clue... Dormant: Gray- to orange-brown twigs bear clustered ovoid pointed gray-brown to reddish buds that may...	Tolerance: Shade intolerant; regeneration and good crown growth require open sun. Site: Adaptable to nutrient-poor, acidic, sandy, and seasonally dry soils if drainage is good; it performs...
Tamarack <i>Larix laricina</i>	Foliage: Soft, slender, blue- to bright-green needles occur singly on elongating current shoots and in dense tufts of... Bark: Young bark is smoothish gray to reddish brown and soon becomes finely scaly. Mature bark sheds as small thin... Dormant: Winter crowns are completely leafless but retain numerous rounded buds on short dark knobby spur...	Tolerance: Very shade intolerant; seedlings may endure light shade briefly but must reach the... Site: Characteristic of bogs, fens, and cold swamps on organic soils, yet best growth often occurs on moist,...
European larch <i>Larix decidua</i>	Foliage: Soft bright-green deciduous needles occur singly on long shoots and in dense tufts on knobby short shoots... Bark: Young branch bark is smooth gray to yellow-brown. Mature trunks develop thick reddish- to gray-brown, deeply... Dormant: Leafless winter twigs carry many rounded buds on stout knobby spur shoots; lateral branchlets...	Tolerance: Very shade intolerant; best stem and crown development require full sun, though... Site: Prefers cool sites with moist, well-drained, moderately fertile loams or gravelly soils; waterlogging...

Taxon	High-value visible evidence	Silvics anchor
Northern white-cedar <i>Thuja occidentalis</i>	Foliage: Tiny opposite scale leaves overlap in four ranks and completely hide the twig, forming strongly flattened fan-... Bark: Sapling bark is thin, smoothish, reddish to gray-brown, and begins peeling in narrow fibers. Mature and old bark... Dormant: Evergreen flattened sprays persist, with no conspicuous scaled winter bud; growth ends in tightly...	Tolerance: Very shade tolerant, able to persist beneath mixed canopies, although successful... Site: Occupies a broad moisture range from swamps and fens to dry cliffs, commonly favored by calcareous or...
Eastern redcedar <i>Juniperus virginiana</i>	Foliage: Adult branchlets carry tiny opposite scale leaves tightly appressed in four ranks, forming rounded to four-... Bark: Young bark is thin reddish brown to gray and begins peeling early. Mature bark shreds in long narrow fibrous... Dormant: Evergreen scale leaves or prickly juvenile leaves persist, and there is no large conspicuous...	Tolerance: Shade intolerant to only weakly tolerant; seedlings establish in open ground and... Site: Extremely site-flexible on dry rocky, sandy, clayey, and calcareous soils, including shallow...
Quaking aspen <i>Populus tremuloides</i>	Foliage: Alternate, simple leaves on normal short shoots are usually nearly round to broadly ovate or rhombic, 2-8 cm... Bark: Young stems have thin, smooth, pale greenish-white to cream bark, often with dark branch scars and horizontal... Dormant: Alternate slender brown to gray-red twigs end in narrow, pointed, usually glabrous buds with...	Tolerance: Very shade intolerant; seedlings and root suckers require nearly full light, and... Site: Occupies a very broad edaphic range, from dry sands and shallow uplands to moist loams and cold...
Bigtooth aspen <i>Populus grandidentata</i>	Foliage: Alternate, simple blades on normal shoots are broadly ovate, usually 7-12 cm long, and bear roughly 5-12... Bark: Saplings have smooth thin olive-green to gray bark with lenticels and dark branch scars. Pole bark becomes dull... Dormant: Alternate gray-brown twigs have a true terminal bud and appressed lateral buds. The several...	Tolerance: Very shade intolerant; successful suckers and seedlings need nearly full overhead... Site: Most characteristic on well-drained sandy or loamy uplands and glacial deposits, but best growth...
Balsam poplar <i>Populus balsamifera</i>	Foliage: Alternate, simple blades are broadly ovate to lance-ovate with a long acute or short-acuminate tip, a broad-... Bark: Young stems have smooth gray-green to brown bark with evident lenticels; pole bark remains relatively smooth and... Dormant: The large, sharply pointed terminal bud is conspicuously resinous, sticky, and strongly balsamic...	Tolerance: Very shade intolerant; regeneration needs nearly full light and is rapidly... Site: Best developed on moist, nutrient-rich, aerated alluvial soils and fresh flood deposits; it also...
Speckled alder <i>Alnus incana subsp. rugosa</i>	Foliage: Alternate, simple leaves are narrow-ovate to elliptic or broadly elliptic, commonly with a rounded to subcordate... Bark: Young brown to gray stems are smooth and densely speckled with conspicuous horizontal or oval white lenticels,... Dormant: Alternate ovoid buds stand on obvious 2-4 mm stalks and are covered by two, sometimes three...	Tolerance: Generally shade intolerant to intermediate; dense thickets persist where crowns... Site: Characteristic of saturated or seasonally flooded mineral and organic soils along streams, shorelines...
American mountain-ash <i>Sorbus americana</i>	Foliage: Leaves are alternate and pinnately compound, generally 10-22 cm long, with a terminal leaflet and numerous... Bark: Young trunks are thin, smooth, gray to gray-brown, with horizontal lenticels; older small boles become somewhat... Dormant: Alternate twigs carry a conspicuous ovoid to pointed terminal bud and smaller lateral buds with...	Tolerance: Shade intolerant overall; it can persist beneath a semiopen canopy but abundance... Site: Most successful on cool moist acidic soils with adequate aeration, but occurs from swamp borders to...
Showy mountain-ash <i>Sorbus decora</i>	Foliage: Alternate pinnately compound leaves commonly carry 13-17 blue-green leaflets. Compared with American mountain-... Bark: Young gray-brown bark is smooth with lenticels; older small boles become scaly or shallowly fissured but remain... Dormant: Alternate twigs end in a conspicuous ovoid to pointed scaly bud. The margins of the winter bud...	Tolerance: Tolerates partial shade but not a deeply closed canopy; crown growth, flowering... Site: Favored by cool moist conditions and occurs on a variety of acidic to neutral substrates, including...
Silver maple <i>Acer saccharinum</i>	Foliage: Leaves are opposite, simple, and usually five-lobed, with very deep sinuses that produce long narrow lobes; the... Bark: Seedlings and saplings have smooth light-gray bark, sometimes with fine vertical lenticels. Intermediate stems... Dormant: Twigs are opposite, slender to moderately stout, reddish brown, and bear blunt red to reddish...	Tolerance: Intermediate to moderately tolerant when young, but best crown development and... Site: Most characteristic on moist alluvial soils and seasonally flooded lowlands; it tolerates considerable...
Boxelder <i>Acer negundo</i>	Foliage: Leaves are opposite and pinnately compound, an unusual combination among regional trees. Each leaf usually has... Bark: Young bark is smooth, thin, and gray to light brown. Intermediate stems develop shallow narrow fissures and low... Dormant: Opposite stout twigs are green, olive, purplish, or brown and often carry a pale waxy bloom. Buds...	Tolerance: Shade intolerant to intermediate when young; it persists best along edges and in... Site: Most frequent on moist fertile alluvium, stream margins, and low terraces, but remarkably tolerant of...
River birch <i>Betula nigra</i>	Foliage: Leaves are alternate, simple, and broadly rhombic to ovate, usually with a wedge-shaped base, acute tip, and... Bark: Young stems and upper branches have salmon, cinnamon, pinkish tan, or cream bark peeling in thin papery curls... Dormant: Slender alternate twigs are reddish brown to gray, lenticellate, and may bear glandular hairs...	Tolerance: Shade intolerant; seedlings need open light and established crowns deteriorate... Site: Best on moist, well-aerated alluvial sands, silts, and loams along waterways; it tolerates periodic...
White ash <i>Fraxinus americana</i>	Foliage: Leaves are opposite and pinnately compound, usually with seven but sometimes five to nine stalked leaflets... Bark: Seedlings and young saplings have smooth gray bark with scattered pale lenticels. Pole-size bark develops... Dormant: Stout opposite brown to blue-brown twigs are normally glabrous. The terminal bud is rounded at...	Tolerance: Young seedlings tolerate shade for a time, but tolerance declines with age... Site: Best on deep, fertile, moist but well-drained loams with favorable nutrient status; it avoids...
Green ash <i>Fraxinus pennsylvanica</i>	Foliage: Leaves are opposite and pinnately compound with five to nine stalked leaflets. Leaflets are usually serrate and... Bark: Young bark is smooth gray-brown with lenticels. Pole and mature stems develop narrow interlacing ridges and... Dormant: Opposite gray-brown branchlets are usually pubescent on current growth, and the terminal bud is...	Tolerance: Variable from intermediate to moderately tolerant when young, with advance... Site: Most characteristic on fertile alluvial clays, silts, and loams subject to periodic flooding, yet...
Black ash <i>Fraxinus nigra</i>	Foliage: Leaves are opposite and pinnately compound with seven to thirteen, occasionally more, narrow sharply serrate... Bark: Sapling bark is smooth light gray and may feel somewhat corky. Intermediate stems develop shallow fissures and... Dormant: Stout opposite twigs bear dark brown to nearly black buds. The terminal bud stands distinctly...	Tolerance: Intermediate when young, with seedlings able to persist under a partial canopy but... Site: Specialized for cold, poorly drained mineral or organic soils, often where nutrient-rich groundwater...
Eastern cottonwood <i>Populus deltoides</i>	Foliage: Leaves are alternate, simple, broadly triangular or deltoid, and often nearly as wide as long, with a truncate... Bark: Seedlings and young branches are smooth yellow-green to gray with lenticels. Intermediate trunks become gray and... Dormant: Twigs are stout, glossy yellow-brown to reddish brown, conspicuously lenticellate, and often...	Tolerance: Very shade intolerant; seedlings and lower crowns decline rapidly when overtopped. Site: Best on deep moist, well-aerated sands and silts deposited along rivers; tolerates periodic flooding...
American elm <i>Ulmus americana</i>	Foliage: Leaves are alternate, simple, usually seven to fourteen centimeters long, ovate to elliptic, abruptly pointed... Bark: Young bark is smooth gray to gray-brown. Intermediate stems form shallow intersecting fissures and flattened... Dormant: Slender alternate twigs form a slight zigzag and generally lack corky wings. Small ovoid brown...	Tolerance: Intermediate to moderately tolerant when young; seedlings can persist beneath a... Site: Broad site amplitude from moist well-drained uplands to seasonally flooded rich alluvium, with best...
Slippery elm <i>Ulmus rubra</i>	Foliage: Leaves are alternate, simple, usually eight to sixteen centimeters long, broad ovate to elliptic, double-... Bark: Young bark is gray-brown and shallowly fissured. Intermediate and mature bark becomes dark gray to reddish brown... Dormant: Alternate zigzag twigs are more often stout and hairy than those of American elm. Ovoid buds have...	Tolerance: Intermediate to tolerant when young, allowing seedlings to persist beneath partial... Site: Best on moist fertile, well-drained loams and calcareous rich woods; occurs on riparian terraces and...

Taxon	High-value visible evidence	Silvics anchor
Rock elm <i>Ulmus thomasi</i>	Foliage: Leaves are alternate, simple, elliptic to obovate or ovate, double-serrate, and usually firm textured, with a... Bark: Young stems are smooth gray-brown. Intermediate bark develops shallow fissures and narrow firm ridges. Mature... Dormant: Alternate twigs are gray, brown, or reddish and lack a true terminal bud. Two- to several-year...	Tolerance: Intermediate in shade tolerance; seedlings persist under partial canopy but need... Site: Most characteristic on well-drained loams, rocky uplands, and calcareous substrates, though it also...
Siberian elm <i>Ulmus pumila</i>	Foliage: Leaves are alternate, simple, small, usually two to six and a half centimeters long, elliptic to lanceolate, and... Bark: Young bark is smooth gray to light brown. Intermediate stems develop shallow fissures and narrow ridges. Mature... Dormant: Slender alternate gray-brown twigs form a zigzag and lack a true terminal bud. Small globose buds...	Tolerance: Shade intolerant; seedlings establish and grow best in open fields, roadsides... Site: Extremely tolerant of drought, cold, wind, alkaline or nutrient-poor soils, and compaction, while also...
Black willow <i>Salix nigra</i>	Foliage: Leaves are alternate, simple, narrowly lanceolate, mostly about 7.5-17 millimeters wide, long-pointed, and... Bark: Young bark is smooth yellow-brown, gray, or reddish brown. Intermediate stems become shallowly fissured with... Dormant: Slender alternate branchlets are yellow, orange, red-brown, or gray, conspicuously lenticellate,...	Tolerance: Very shade intolerant; seedlings and lower crowns decline rapidly beneath taller... Site: Requires a continuous growing-season water supply and is most competitive on very wet alluvial silts,...
American sycamore <i>Platanus occidentalis</i>	Foliage: Leaves are alternate, simple, broad, palmately veined, and usually three to five shallow or moderate lobes with... Bark: Young stems are gray-brown and smoothish. Intermediate trunks begin exfoliating in irregular thin plates that... Dormant: Stout alternate twigs zigzag between nodes and show a complete stipule-scar ring encircling each...	Tolerance: Very shade intolerant; seedlings need open light and crowns self-prune or decline... Site: Best on deep moist, fertile, well-aerated alluvial loams and sands along streams; tolerates periodic...
Northern red oak <i>Quercus rubra</i>	Foliage: Alternate leaves usually have 7-11 bristle-tipped lobes, sinuses generally extending less than halfway to the... Bark: Young stems are smooth gray-brown. Saplings and pole timber develop long smooth pale vertical bands between... Dormant: Stout reddish-brown to gray-brown twigs end in a cluster of several pointed, reddish-brown,...	Tolerance: Intermediate in shade tolerance; seedlings can persist for a time beneath partial... Site: Best on deep, fertile, moist but well-drained loams and silt loams; it occupies a broad site range but...
Black oak <i>Quercus velutina</i>	Foliage: Alternate leaves are extremely variable, usually with 5-9 bristle-tipped lobes and sinuses ranging from shallow... Bark: Young bark is smooth gray. It darkens early and becomes thick, deeply furrowed, and blocky on mature stems,... Dormant: Twigs are moderately stout and reddish-brown to gray, ending in a cluster of relatively large,...	Tolerance: Intermediate but light-demanding for successful recruitment; seedlings may persist... Site: Occurs from dry sandy and rocky uplands to moist rich well-drained loams; it avoids prolonged...
Scarlet oak <i>Quercus coccinea</i>	Foliage: Alternate glossy leaves usually have 7-9 narrow bristle-tipped lobes and deep broad C- or U-shaped sinuses... Bark: Sapling bark is smooth gray-brown. Mature bark becomes dark gray to nearly black with irregular narrow ridges... Dormant: Slender reddish-brown twigs end in clustered ovoid, pointed reddish-brown buds that may be finely...	Tolerance: Intermediate to intolerant and strongly light-demanding for successful... Site: Most characteristic of dry, acidic, well-drained sandy or rocky soils on ridges and upper slopes;...
Northern pin oak <i>Quercus ellipsoidalis</i>	Foliage: Alternate leaves commonly have 5-7 narrow bristle-tipped lobes separated by deep rounded sinuses, with a mostly... Bark: Young bark is smooth gray-brown; older stems develop shallow fissures and irregular dark gray to blackish... Dormant: Reddish-brown twigs end in a clustered group of small ovoid to conic reddish-brown buds, hairless...	Tolerance: Very intolerant of shade; it does not regenerate successfully beneath its own... Site: Specialized on dry acidic, nutrient-poor sands and sandy or sandstone uplands with a thin organic...
Pin oak <i>Quercus palustris</i>	Foliage: Alternate leaves usually have 5-7 narrow bristle-tipped lobes divided by deep broad U-shaped sinuses. The lower... Bark: Young and pole-size trees retain thin, smooth gray-brown bark for many years. Older boles become shallowly... Dormant: Slender reddish-brown twigs end in clusters of small pointed chestnut-brown buds that are usually...	Tolerance: Intolerant of shade; overtopped seedlings and intermediates decline quickly, and... Site: Characteristic of poorly drained, seasonally flooded heavy clays, glacial till flats, and bottomlands;...
White oak <i>Quercus alba</i>	Foliage: Alternate leaves have 7-9 rounded, bristleless lobes, with sinuses ranging from shallow to deep and an often... Bark: Young stems are smooth light gray to brownish gray. Pole and mature bark becomes pale ashy gray and breaks into... Dormant: Gray to reddish twigs terminate in a tight cluster of short, blunt to ovoid reddish-brown, mostly...	Tolerance: Intermediate and generally more shade tolerant as a seedling than the most light... Site: Occupies a broad range from dry ridges to moist well-drained coves, growing best on deep fertile loams...
Swamp white oak <i>Quercus bicolor</i>	Foliage: Alternate obovate leaves have shallow irregular rounded lobes or coarse rounded teeth and a wedge-shaped base... Bark: Young bark is smooth gray-brown. Older bark becomes gray, scaly, and irregularly flaky, often peeling in strips... Dormant: Yellow-brown to gray-brown twigs carry clustered short blunt buds; young twigs may be somewhat...	Tolerance: Intermediate; seedlings can establish under moderate shade but require release for... Site: Most common on hydromorphic mineral, alluvial, or organic soils with imperfect to poor drainage and...
Bur oak <i>Quercus macrocarpa</i>	Foliage: Alternate leaves are large and obovate with rounded bristleless lobes, commonly narrowed by a pair of very deep... Bark: Young bark is gray and becomes corky at an early age. Mature boles have very thick dark gray-brown bark divided... Dormant: Stout gray-brown twigs end in clustered short rounded buds and commonly develop conspicuous corky...	Tolerance: Intermediate but unable to recruit indefinitely under dense shade; seedlings and... Site: Exceptionally broad, from droughty sands, thin limestone ridges, claypans, and prairie loams to moist...
Chestnut oak <i>Quercus montana</i>	Foliage: Alternate obovate to elliptic leaves are unlobed but have 10-16 pairs of large rounded crenate teeth, resembling... Bark: Young bark is smooth gray-brown. Mature bark becomes exceptionally thick, dark gray-brown, and deeply divided by... Dormant: Stout reddish- to gray-brown twigs end in clustered pointed reddish-brown buds, sometimes finely...	Tolerance: Intermediate; seedlings may persist beneath an open canopy but successful... Site: Most characteristic of dry, rocky, well-drained acidic sandstone and shale ridges with low fertility,...
Common hackberry <i>Celtis occidentalis</i>	Foliage: Alternate simple ovate leaves have a strongly unequal, oblique base, three prominent veins arising near the... Bark: Young bark is smooth gray-brown with lenticels. Intermediate stems develop isolated corky warts, and mature gray... Dormant: Slender alternate twigs are often zigzag, reddish-brown to gray, with small appressed ovoid...	Tolerance: Intermediate to tolerant; seedlings may persist in dense shade, although prolonged... Site: Grows on many soils but is strongest on fertile valley alluvium, riparian terraces, and calcareous or...
American chestnut <i>Castanea dentata</i>	Foliage: Leaves are alternate, simple, narrowly elliptic to lanceolate, commonly 12-22 cm long, with a long pointed tip... Bark: Seedlings, sprouts, and young stems have smooth olive-brown to gray-brown bark with conspicuous pale lenticels... Dormant: Alternate slender reddish-brown twigs are glabrous and bear small ovoid to conical brown buds...	Tolerance: Seedlings and sprouts can persist for years under partial shade, but sustained... Site: Historically occupied a wide range but was especially successful on well-drained acidic loams and...
Bitternut hickory <i>Carya cordiformis</i>	Foliage: Leaves are alternate and pinnately compound, usually with 7 or 9 narrowly ovate to lanceolate serrate leaflets;... Bark: Saplings have relatively smooth gray bark. Pole and mature stems develop shallow furrows and narrow interlacing... Dormant: The high-value character is a slender pointed terminal bud with sulfur-yellow to mustard-yellow,...	Tolerance: Intermediate; seedlings can persist under partial canopy, but vigorous height... Site: Best on deep, fertile, moist, well-aerated loams of bottomlands, terraces, and rich uplands, though it...
Shagbark hickory <i>Carya ovata</i>	Foliage: Alternate pinnately compound leaves usually have 5 leaflets, less often 7; the terminal leaflet and upper... Bark: Seedlings and saplings have smooth gray bark, and pole trees develop close shallow ridges before any shag... Dormant: Twigs are stout, alternate, and contain solid pith. The terminal bud is large, ovoid, and brown...	Tolerance: Intermediate; seedlings can survive beneath partial canopy but require release to... Site: Grows from dry uplands to moist lowlands, with best growth on deep fertile well-drained loams; it is...

Taxon	High-value visible evidence	Silvics anchor
Pignut hickory <i>Carya glabra</i>	Foliage: Alternate pinnately compound leaves most often have 5 leaflets, sometimes 7; the upper three are larger, and... Bark: Young stems are smooth gray. Mature bark is gray to dark gray with close, interlacing, often diamond-patterned... Dormant: Alternate slender to moderately stout twigs have solid pith and a small ovoid to ellipsoid...	Tolerance: Intermediate overall but often treated as relatively intolerant in the Northeast... Site: Most characteristic of well-drained dry to mesic uplands, ridges, and slopes on loams or rocky soils;...
Mockernut hickory <i>Carya tomentosa</i>	Foliage: Alternate pinnately compound leaves usually have 7 leaflets, sometimes 5 or 9. Leaflets are broad, serrate, and... Bark: Sapling bark is gray and relatively smooth. Mature bark becomes dark gray with deep furrows and close... Dormant: Twigs are notably stout and often densely pubescent, with solid pith and large three-lobed leaf...	Tolerance: Intermediate; established seedlings can persist beneath partial cover, but good... Site: Most characteristic of well-drained dry to mesic uplands on loams and rocky soils, while best growth...
Black walnut <i>Juglans nigra</i>	Foliage: Alternate pinnately compound leaves commonly have 11-23 finely serrate leaflets. The terminal leaflet is absent... Bark: Young bark is gray-brown and relatively smooth with lenticels. Pole bark develops narrow fissures, while mature... Dormant: Alternate stout brown twigs show large shield- or heart-shaped leaf scars with three main groups...	Tolerance: Shade intolerant; seedlings may survive briefly under partial cover but need early... Site: Best on deep, fertile, moist, well-drained loams with near-neutral reaction, often on alluvium,...
Butternut <i>Juglans cinerea</i>	Foliage: Alternate pinnately compound leaves usually have 11-17 serrate leaflets and a well-developed terminal leaflet... Bark: Young bark is smooth gray with lenticels. Mature bark is light gray to ashy, divided by shallow furrows into... Dormant: Stout gray-brown current twigs are densely hairy, often with a hairy ridge or pad immediately...	Tolerance: Shade intolerant; seedlings and sprouts need substantial light, and established... Site: Best on fertile moist well-drained soils of stream terraces, coves, and slopes, often with calcareous...
Blackgum <i>Nyssa sylvatica</i>	Foliage: Alternate simple leaves are elliptic to obovate, usually entire but occasionally with a few coarse teeth, with a... Bark: Young trunks are gray and shallowly furrowed. Mature bark develops irregular vertical ridges and then breaks... Dormant: Alternate gray-brown to reddish twigs bear small ovoid to conical, reddish-brown, many-scaled...	Tolerance: Tolerant; seedlings can persist under closed hardwood cover, although near-full... Site: Extremely broad site amplitude, from dry acidic ridges to moist loams and stream bottoms; best growth...
Sassafras <i>Sassafras albidum</i>	Foliage: Alternate simple leaves can be unlobed and oval, asymmetrically one-lobed like a mitten, or symmetrically three-... Bark: Young stems and branches are smooth green to reddish green with pale lenticels. Pole bark turns orange-brown and... Dormant: Alternate greenish to reddish aromatic twigs have solid pith and a true terminal bud. Vegetative...	Tolerance: Shade intolerant; seedlings and root sprouts grow best in full or nearly full... Site: Occupies many soils but is most conspicuous on well-drained sandy or loamy old fields, ridges, and...
Cucumbertree <i>Magnolia acuminata</i>	Foliage: Alternate simple leaves are large, commonly 10-25 cm long, elliptic to oblong, entire, and abruptly to gradually... Bark: Young stems have thin smooth gray-brown bark with scattered lenticels. Pole bark begins to fissure; mature bark... Dormant: Alternate stout reddish-brown twigs bear large silky gray-green to brown terminal buds enclosed...	Tolerance: Intermediate; young plants tolerate some side shade, but regeneration is more... Site: Best on deep, fertile, moist, well-drained loams of coves, valleys, and lower slopes; poorly drained,...
Tuliptree <i>Liriodendron tulipifera</i>	Foliage: Alternate simple leaves are broadly four-lobed, with two lobes on each side and a squared, truncate, or... Bark: Seedlings and saplings have smooth dark greenish-gray bark with pale vertical lenticels. Pole bark develops... Dormant: Alternate twigs are reddish brown, aromatic when lawfully scraped or broken, and ringed at each...	Tolerance: Shade intolerant; seedlings may persist briefly under light cover, but dominant... Site: Best on deep, fertile, moist, well-drained loams of coves, lower slopes, and alluvial terraces; growth...
Flowering dogwood <i>Cornus florida</i>	Foliage: Leaves and twigs are opposite. Simple oval to ovate blades have entire or slightly wavy margins and three to... Bark: Young stems are smooth gray to gray-brown. As stems mature, bark breaks into many small, nearly square or... Dormant: Opposite slender twigs end either in a narrow pointed vegetative bud or a conspicuous rounded,...	Tolerance: Tolerant of understory shade, though flowering, fruiting, and crown vigor improve... Site: Occurs from dry uplands to moist stream-adjacent soils but is most frequent on well-drained,...
Pitch pine <i>Pinus rigida</i>	Foliage: Stout, rigid, yellow-green needles are usually in fascicles of three, less often two, with persistent basal... Bark: Young bark is reddish-brown and scaly; intermediate and mature boles develop thick, dark gray-brown irregular... Dormant: Stout shoots carry clustered resinous pointed buds, persistent fascicle sheaths, and often short...	Tolerance: Shade intolerant; seedlings and sprouts need strong light, and associated... Site: Most characteristic on infertile acidic sands, gravels, and shallow rocky soils, but also occupies...
Atlantic white-cedar <i>Chamaecyparis thyoides</i>	Foliage: Minute opposite scale leaves overlap in four ranks on slender blue-green branchlets that appear more four-angled... Bark: Young bark is thin reddish-brown; older stems separate into narrow flat fibrous strips and shallow intersecting... Dormant: Evergreen sprays retain tiny appressed scales through winter; buds are inconspicuous and...	Tolerance: Generally shade intolerant; seedlings tolerate brief partial cover but successful... Site: Restricted mainly to saturated, acidic, low-nutrient organic soils, peat, muck, and wet sands where...

Part III - Fillable instructional sessions

Complete sessions in order when possible. Closed-book retrieval means close or hide the teaching atlas before answering.

Session A - Planted and invasive confusers

Purpose: native-versus-invasive character combinations. Taxon scope: listed new taxa plus cs20 and cs24 members. Feedback: during instruction.

Before the session: which species or comparison currently feels least reliable?

Black locust: one diagnostic character plus one silvics anchor

Tree-of-heaven: one diagnostic character plus one silvics anchor

White mulberry: one diagnostic character plus one silvics anchor

Exit retrieval: state the most important correction or strengthened distinction

☐ Session A complete (enter X)

Session B - Winter and invasive-confuser retrieval

Purpose: unfamiliar partial winter specimens. Taxon scope: session a taxa plus due dormant remediation. Feedback: after batch submission.

Before the session: which species or comparison currently feels least reliable?

1. Silvics

Place Scarlet oak in succession: give its shade tolerance, explain how it recruits or persists, and characterize its longevity or growth strategy.

Response

closed-book retrieval

2. Silvics

Place European larch in succession: give its shade tolerance, explain how it recruits or persists, and characterize its longevity or growth strategy.

Response

closed-book retrieval

3. Nomenclature

Which course taxon is named *Tsuga canadensis*? Give its preferred common name.

Response

closed-book retrieval

4. Silvics

Explain how Northern red oak normally regenerates, including establishment requirements and any seed, mast, sprouting, layering, or suckering behavior that materially affects a prescription.

Response

closed-book retrieval

5. Silvics

For American mountain-ash (*Sorbus americana*), describe the moisture, drainage, and soil setting a forester should expect, then place it in its climatic or forest-association context.

Response

closed-book retrieval

6. Silvics

A stand prescription lists Tuliptree as an objective species. State the site conditions that favor it and one site or climatic constraint that would make that objective questionable.

Response

closed-book retrieval

7. Silvics

After a harvest, what regeneration pathway should a forester expect from Jack pine, and what substrate, light, moisture, or advance-regeneration conditions control success?

Response

closed-book retrieval

8. Silvics

Give one operational management implication for Butternut and explain its response to an appropriate silvicultural system or cutting pattern.

Response

closed-book retrieval

9. Silvics

Place Heart-leaved paper birch in succession: give its shade tolerance, explain how it recruits or persists, and characterize its longevity or growth strategy.

Response

closed-book retrieval

10. Silvics

Give one operational management implication for Black ash and explain its response to an appropriate silvicultural system or cutting pattern.

Response

closed-book retrieval

Exit retrieval: state the most important correction or strengthened distinction

☐ Session B complete (enter X)

Session C - American beech condition laboratory

Purpose: host-identification and condition-diagnosis stations scored separately. Taxon scope: *fagus grandifolia* full condition sequence plus bark confusers. Feedback: after response.

Before the session: which species or comparison currently feels least reliable?

Sugar / black / Norway maple

Course separator: Petiole latex; leaf underside hair and stipules; bud size/shape; samara angle

My visible separator

Best resolving view

Red / silver maple

Course separator: Sinus depth; lower-surface whiteness; spring samara size; twig odor; bark strips

My visible separator

Best resolving view

Striped / mountain maple

Course separator: Green-white striped bark versus unstriped; leaf size/base; fruit cluster posture; growth form

My visible separator

Best resolving view

White / green / black ash

Course separator: Leaf-scar shape and bud position; leaflet stalks; samara wing extent; black-ash corky bark

My visible separator

Best resolving view

Paper / heart-leaved / gray birch

Course separator: Leaf base and vein count; twig resin glands; peeling versus tight bark; black branch marks; elevation

My visible separator

Best resolving view

Yellow / sweet birch

Course separator: Both wintergreen; yellow birch golden curling bark and spur shoots versus sweet birch dark blocky bark

My visible separator

Best resolving view

White / black / red / Norway spruce

Course separator: Cone size and scale margin; twig hairs; bud resin; foliage color/odor; pendulous branchlets

My visible separator

Best resolving view

Spruce / fir / hemlock

Course separator: Woody pegs versus pad base versus petiole; needle cross-section; cone orientation and persistence

My visible separator

Best resolving view

Red / jack / Scots / pitch pine

Course separator: Fascicle count/length; bend test; cone curvature/prickles; upper-bole orange bark; epicormic shoots

My visible separator

Best resolving view

Tamarack / European larch

Course separator: Cone size and scale count/edge; needle cluster density; native peatland versus planting

My visible separator

Best resolving view

Red-oak group

Course separator: Bud hair/size; lower-leaf hair; sinus architecture; acorn cup depth/rings; bark; site and branch angle

My visible separator

Best resolving view

White-oak group

Course separator: Lower-leaf felt; fruit stalk; fringed cup; chestnut teeth; bark architecture; site

My visible separator

Best resolving view

Aspens / balsam poplar / cottonwood

Course separator: Petiole flattening; tooth size; leaf base; bud size/stickiness/odor; bark and floodplain/upland context

My visible separator

Best resolving view

American / slippery / rock / Siberian elm

Course separator: Leaf roughness/base; bud hair; corky wings; samara hair/notch; bark layering; crown

My visible separator

Best resolving view

Black / pin / chokecherry

Course separator: Fruit cluster architecture; petiole glands; lower-midvein hair; bark age; whole pioneer/clonal form

My visible separator

Best resolving view

American hornbeam / eastern hophornbeam

Course separator: Muscular smooth bole and three-lobed fruit bracts versus shreddy bark and hoplike sacs

My visible separator

Best resolving view

Black walnut / butternut

Course separator: Terminal leaflet; rachis/twig hair; light versus dark pith; round versus elongated nut; bark

My visible separator

Best resolving view

Bitternut / shagbark / pignut / mockernut hickory

Course separator: Terminal bud color/size/hair; leaflet count; rachis hair; husk thickness/dehiscence; bark

My visible separator

Best resolving view

Northern white-cedar / Atlantic white-cedar / eastern redcedar

Course separator: Flattened fans versus fine false-cypress sprays versus rounded juniper twigs; cone type; fruit color; wetland chemistry

My visible separator

Best resolving view

Native compound leaves / invasive confusers

Course separator: Opposite/alternate; bud position; leaflet glands; thorns; pith; leaf scar; odor; fruit type

My visible separator

Best resolving view

Yellow birch / black cherry bark

Course separator: Golden horizontal curls and wintergreen twig versus burnt-chip plates, petiole glands, and almond twig odor

My visible separator

Best resolving view

Serviceberry / mountain-ashes / chokecherry

Course separator: Simple versus compound leaves; pome calyx versus drupe; leaflet proportions; buds; fruit architecture

My visible separator

Best resolving view

Flowering / pagoda dogwood

Course separator: Opposite versus alternate branching; red versus blue-black fruit; flower bud; crown tiers

My visible separator

Best resolving view

White mulberry / sassafras / basswood

Course separator: Latex and variable coarse leaves; sassafras aroma/mixed shapes; basswood asymmetric heart base and bracted fruit

My visible separator

Best resolving view

Exit retrieval: state the most important correction or strengthened distinction

☐ Session C complete (enter X)

Session D - Adversarial winter and damage laboratory

Purpose: poor views damaged material disease effects and insufficient-evidence stations. Taxon scope: all taxa with required condition and winter emphasis. Feedback: after station batch submission.

Before the session: which species or comparison currently feels least reliable?

Practice 1

Identity: common OR scientific name



Evidence asset INAT_PHOTO_584458583 | credit in Sources appendix

Only the identity field is universally required. Instructors may score reasoning fields where the rubric calls for a field decision.
Use genus or 'insufficient evidence' when the photograph cannot defend species.

Required - defensible identity

Confidence: low / moderate / high

Nearest plausible alternative

Visible separator / evidence

Best additional view if unresolved

Practice 2

Identity: common OR scientific name



Evidence asset INAT_PHOTO_720866543 | credit in Sources appendix

Only the identity field is universally required. Instructors may score reasoning fields where the rubric calls for a field decision.
Use genus or 'insufficient evidence' when the photograph cannot defend species.

Required - defensible identity

Confidence: low / moderate / high

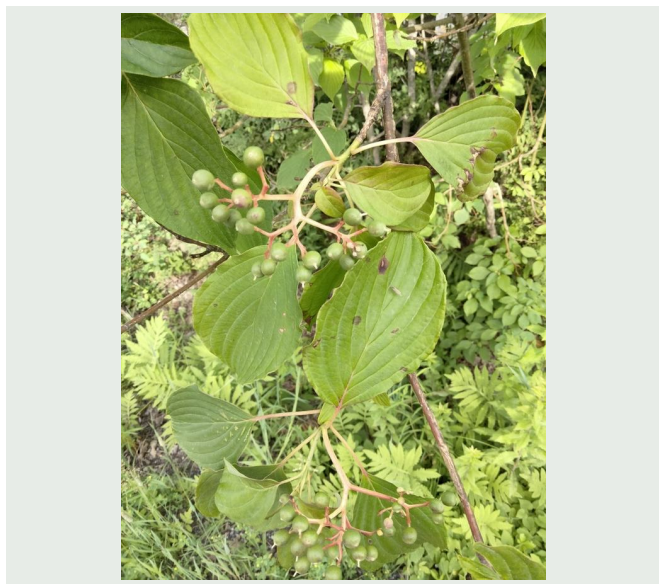
Nearest plausible alternative

Visible separator / evidence

Best additional view if unresolved

Practice 3

Identity: common OR scientific name



Evidence asset INAT_PHOTO_698363566 | credit in Sources appendix

Only the identity field is universally required. Instructors may score reasoning fields where the rubric calls for a field decision.
Use genus or 'insufficient evidence' when the photograph cannot defend species.

Required - defensible identity

Confidence: low / moderate / high

Nearest plausible alternative

Visible separator / evidence

Best additional view if unresolved

Practice 4

Identity: common OR scientific name



Evidence asset INAT_PHOTO_629373071 | credit in Sources appendix

Only the identity field is universally required. Instructors may score reasoning fields where the rubric calls for a field decision.
Use genus or 'insufficient evidence' when the photograph cannot defend species.

Required - defensible identity

Confidence: low / moderate / high

Nearest plausible alternative

Visible separator / evidence

Best additional view if unresolved

Practice 5

Identity: common OR scientific name



Evidence asset INAT_PHOTO_45924179 | credit in Sources appendix

Only the identity field is universally required. Instructors may score reasoning fields where the rubric calls for a field decision.
Use genus or 'insufficient evidence' when the photograph cannot defend species.

Required - defensible identity

Confidence: low / moderate / high

Nearest plausible alternative

Visible separator / evidence

Best additional view if unresolved

Practice 6

Identity: common OR scientific name



Evidence asset INAT_PHOTO_721264069 | credit in Sources appendix

Only the identity field is universally required. Instructors may score reasoning fields where the rubric calls for a field decision.
Use genus or 'insufficient evidence' when the photograph cannot defend species.

Required - defensible identity

Confidence: low / moderate / high

Nearest plausible alternative

Visible separator / evidence

Best additional view if unresolved

Practice 7

Identity: common OR scientific name



Evidence asset INAT_PHOTO_716406792 | credit in Sources appendix

Only the identity field is universally required. Instructors may score reasoning fields where the rubric calls for a field decision.
Use genus or 'insufficient evidence' when the photograph cannot defend species.

Required - defensible identity

Confidence: low / moderate / high

Nearest plausible alternative

Visible separator / evidence

Best additional view if unresolved

Practice 8

Identity: common OR scientific name



Evidence asset INAT_PHOTO_511217089 | credit in Sources appendix

Only the identity field is universally required. Instructors may score reasoning fields where the rubric calls for a field decision.
Use genus or 'insufficient evidence' when the photograph cannot defend species.

Required - defensible identity

Confidence: low / moderate / high

Nearest plausible alternative

Visible separator / evidence

Best additional view if unresolved

Practice 9

Identity: common OR scientific name



Evidence asset INAT_PHOTO_675547544 | credit in Sources appendix

Only the identity field is universally required. Instructors may score reasoning fields where the rubric calls for a field decision.
Use genus or 'insufficient evidence' when the photograph cannot defend species.

Required - defensible identity

Confidence: low / moderate / high

Nearest plausible alternative

Visible separator / evidence

Best additional view if unresolved

Practice 10

Identity: common OR scientific name



Evidence asset INAT_PHOTO_648803755 | credit in Sources appendix

Only the identity field is universally required. Instructors may score reasoning fields where the rubric calls for a field decision.
Use genus or 'insufficient evidence' when the photograph cannot defend species.

Required - defensible identity

Confidence: low / moderate / high

Nearest plausible alternative

Visible separator / evidence

Best additional view if unresolved

Exit retrieval: state the most important correction or strengthened distinction

☐ Session D complete (enter X)

Session E - No weak species disappears

Purpose: adversarial adaptive retrieval and targeted remediation. Taxon scope: all 80 taxa prioritized by error ledger and certification deficits.
Feedback: after batch submission.

Before the session: which species or comparison currently feels least reliable?

1. Nomenclature

Which course taxon is named *Pinus sylvestris*? Give its preferred common name.

Response

closed-book retrieval

2. Nomenclature

Translate this preferred common name into the canonical binomial: Speckled alder.

Response

closed-book retrieval

3. Silvics

Give one operational management implication for Black oak and explain its response to an appropriate silvicultural system or cutting pattern.

Response

closed-book retrieval

4. Silvics

Place Atlantic white-cedar in succession: give its shade tolerance, explain how it recruits or persists, and characterize its longevity or growth strategy.

Response

closed-book retrieval

5. Nomenclature

Write the full genus and specific epithet for the course taxon called Heart-leaved paper birch.

Response

closed-book retrieval

6. Nomenclature

Give the accepted scientific name for Boxelder.

Response

closed-book retrieval

7. Nomenclature

Which course taxon is named *Acer negundo*? Give its preferred common name.

Response

closed-book retrieval

8. Silvics

Design the species-specific part of a prescription for Slippery elm: state what to protect or control, and justify the cutting or regeneration approach from its known response.

Response

closed-book retrieval

9. Forest Association

A field crew reports Tamarack from an unfamiliar stand. State the regional and community context that would make the report credible, then request morphological evidence needed to confirm it.

Response

closed-book retrieval

10. Silvics

Explain how Striped maple normally regenerates, including establishment requirements and any seed, mast, sprouting, layering, or suckering behavior that materially affects a prescription.

Response

closed-book retrieval

Exit retrieval: state the most important correction or strengthened distinction

☐ Session E complete (enter X)

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Species-profile references

Black Locust - Silvics of North America: <https://research.fs.usda.gov/silvics/black-locust> - Range, sites, nitrogen fixation, seed and clonal reproduction, intolerance, growth, damaging agents, uses, and management.

Robinia pseudoacacia - black locust: <https://gobotany.nativeplanttrust.org/species/robinia/pseudoacacia/> - Regional compound leaves, stipular spines, buds, bark, flowers, pods, habitat, and comparison characters.

Ailanthus altissima, tree-of-heaven - Fire Effects Information System: <https://research.fs.usda.gov/feis/species-reviews/ailalt> - Distribution, sites, seed and clonal reproduction, succession, disturbance and fire response, allelopathy, control, and wildlife interactions.

Ailanthus altissima - tree-of-heaven: <https://gobotany.nativeplanttrust.org/species/ailanthus/altissima/> - Regional foliage, glandular leaflet teeth, twigs, pith, leaf scars, samaras, habitat, and compound-leaved confusers.

Morus alba - white mulberry: <https://gobotany.nativeplanttrust.org/species/morus/alba/> - Regional leaves, latex, buds, bark, flowers, multiple fruit, habitat, variation, hybridization, and red-mulberry comparison.

Morus alba - White Mulberry: <https://plants.ces.ncsu.edu/plants/morus-alba/> - Habit, site tolerance, growth, reproduction, bark, leaf variation, fruit, wildlife use, pests, and landscape behavior.